

User / Profile / ProfileUser Architecture

Purpose

Future-scaling revision

Scope

Account and profile identity model

Status

Core model approved with corrections

REVISED VERDICT

The separation of **User** (authentication), **Profile** (product identity), and **ProfileUser** (a user's relationship to a profile) is sound. For future scaling, one correction is recommended: professional ownership should use the same relationship layer from the start. The MVP limit of one professional profile per user may remain, but it must be documented as a removable product policy rather than a permanent identity-model invariant.

The key correction

CURRENT REVIEW

professional_profiles.user_id directly owns one professional profile and **unique(user_id)** enforces at most one professional profile per user. The document says the professional side can migrate to ProfileUser later if delegation is needed.

RECOMMENDED FUTURE-SAFE MODEL

Remove ownership from the professional subtype. Connect professional owners through **ProfileUser**, just as athlete and guardian users are connected. This supports multiple profile contexts, delegated professional access, organization seats, and profile switching without changing the identity model later.

Recommended shape

```
users
profiles (id, profile_type)
profile_users (profile_id, user_id, role, status)
athlete_profiles (profile_id, ...)
professional_profiles (profile_id, professional_type, ...)
organizations + organization_memberships (later, separate from personal profiles)
```

What unique(user_id) should mean

- **In the MVP UI:** a user may create at most one professional profile.
- **In the long-term model:** one user may be related to multiple profiles and professional contexts.
- If the database enforces the MVP limit, the constraint must be explicitly removable and covered by a migration/test plan.
- Do not describe ≤ 1 professional profile per user as the only permanent constraint that makes multi-profile scaling work.

PRODUCT DECISION

If UnicAthlete is certain that a person will always have one personal professional identity and will join multiple organizations through memberships, **unique(user_id)** can remain permanent. If multiple professional personas or profile types may be owned by one user, it must be an MVP-only limit. The current product direction says it is MVP-only.

Revised answers to the five questions

Q1 — Does it support athlete, scout, guardian, and future profile types?

Yes, with a naming clarification. Athlete and Professional remain profile types. Guardian remains a relationship role. Future Coach may be a professional type; Fan should be added only if it becomes a real product identity rather than an account capability.

Q2 — Is ProfileUser the right relationship layer?

Yes, and it should be used consistently. Professional ownership should not bypass it. One relationship model is simpler to authorize, audit, switch, and extend than an athlete many-to-many path plus a separate professional owner foreign key.

Q3 — How should roles and permissions be stored?

Keep a stable relationship role and derived policy rules. JSONB may hold optional or evolving overrides, but it should not be the only source for security-critical permissions. Validate its schema and keep immutable consent/permission history in dedicated records rather than only a mutable consent_state field.

Q4 — Can multiple users connect to one athlete profile?

Yes. Keep unique(profile_id, user_id), allow multiple active guardians when the product permits them, and enforce at most one active athlete-user relationship per athlete profile. Relationship status must distinguish invited, active, revoked, and expired connections.

Q5 — Can one user have athlete and professional profiles?

Yes. ProfileUser should link the same User to each relevant profile. The MVP can hide additional professional-profile creation without making that cardinality a permanent model limitation.

Authorization and scaling notes

- Use database Row Level Security where supported, plus application/service authorization and automated policy tests. RLS is a critical boundary, not the sole control.
- Keep joint profile state, such as the effective 16–17 communication mode, separate from per-user relationship permissions; preserve each person's decision history separately.
- Model organizations and their seats/memberships separately from a person's professional profile. A scout changing employers should not require a new authentication identity.
- Prefer explicit status/history records for invitations, relationships, consent, and verification rather than overwriting one mutable field without audit history.
- Keep profile switching as a UI limitation in the MVP, not a database limitation.

Recommended constraints

Constraint	Recommendation
One relationship per user/profile	Keep unique(profile_id, user_id).
One athlete-user per athlete profile	Keep as a conditional active-role constraint.
Professional owners	Use ProfileUser role=owner; one active owner per profile in MVP.
One professional profile per user	MVP policy only unless Product declares one personal professional identity forever.
Multiple guardians	Model-capable; MVP UI may restrict creation while allowing later expansion.
Organization participation	Separate organization membership, not additional auth accounts.

Decision for the Lead Developer

REQUESTED REVISION

Please confirm one of two approaches: **(A)** adopt ProfileUser for professional ownership now (recommended), or **(B)** retain professional_profiles.user_id as a consciously temporary MVP shortcut and document the exact migration trigger. In both cases, confirm that the current one-professional-profile limit is a product/UI constraint unless Product explicitly declares it permanent.